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விவசாயத் திணைக்களம்
Department of Agriculture

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Pests of Rice – Thrips

A pest of young rice seedlings. **Adults and nymphs** suck the cell sap from leaf tissues. Damaged leaves roll inwards along the margins, feeding cause leaf drying and leads to a poor crop growth.

The damage

- The damage is severe under water stress conditions.
- Later planted crops are more prone for damage.

Resistant Rice varieties for thrips.

- Short-age traditional rice varieties such as.
    - Dahanala
    - Kaluheenati
    - Kalubalawee
- Varieties having a higher trichome density on the leaf surface, such varieties are found to be resistant to Thrips.

Thrips management

- Submerge infested crops intermittently for 1-2 days.
- Drag a wet cloth on the seedlings.
- If the control of pests if difficult, then apply recommended insecticides.
- If plants are grown in endemic areas, a recommended seed-dressing formulation could be used.
- Seasonal cultivation.